PANJAB UNIVERSITY, CHANDIGARH

Outlines of tests, syllabi and courses of reading in the subject of Political Science for M.Phil. Course (Semester System) for the year 2012-2013.

All papers are compulsory. The total credits for the M.Phil Programme is 24 credits.

Ist Semester	**Name of Paper**	**Credits: 12**
Paper I	Philosophy of Social Sciences	4 Credits
Paper II	Methods in Social Science	4 Credits
Paper III	Reading and Writing in Social Sciences	4 Credits
2nd Semester		**Credits: 12**
Paper IV	Seminar Paper	3 credits
Paper V	Dissertation	9 credits
		Total Credits: 24

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PAPER-SETTERS AND CANDIDATES

M. Phil. I Semester

Paper I and II

1. The question papers will consist of 60 marks each. 40 marks will be for Term Papers, Case Studies, Book Reviews related to the concerned papers.

2. The final written examination shall have 8 questions in all. The candidates shall be required to attempt any 4 questions carrying 15 marks each. The duration of the examination will be of 3 hours.

Paper III

1. This paper will focus more on a system of continuous evaluation and less on written examination. 80 marks will be for continuous evaluation through Literature Review (50), Book Review (15) and Writing Summaries/Abstracts (15). The Written Test will carry 20 marks.
2. In the written test, a candidate has to answer 2 out of 4 questions. The questions are meant to check on their critical reading skills. Each question will carry 10 marks. The duration of the examination will be of 2 hours.

M. Phil. II Semester

Paper IV

The Seminar paper will consist of 75 marks out of which 50 marks shall be for the submitted seminar paper and 25 marks on the viva-voce based on the seminar paper.

Paper V

The dissertation will be of 225 Marks out of which 175 marks would be based on evaluation of the dissertation and 50 marks would be for viva-voce test.

Paper I : Philosophy of Social Sciences (Compulsory)

This course aims at introducing the main themes in the philosophy of social sciences. This will familiarize them with the main debates over the nature of social science research.

1. The natural science-social science debate: From a science of society to critical science studies.
2. Concepts and theories in social science
3. Objectivity, value neutrality, relativism
4. Explanations in social science: causality, laws and prediction.
5. Interpretation and understanding
6. Rational Choice
7. Marxism and Critical theory
8. Feminism
9. Structuralism and Post Structuralism
10. Postmodernism

Reading List:

1. Taylor, Charles, *Philosophical Papers,* Vol.2, Cambridge: CUP, 1985.
2. Weber, Max, *Methodology of the Social Sciences,* London, 1964.
3. Winch, P, *The Idea of a Social Science,* London, Routledge and Kegan Paul, 1958.
4. Mahajan, Gurpreet, Explanation and Understanding in the Human Sciences, New Delhi, OUP, 1997.
5. *Open the Social Sciences*, Report of the Gulbenkian Commission on the Restructuring of the Social Sciences, Standford University Press, Stanford, 1996.
6. Malcolm Williams, *Science and Social Sciences,* London and New York, Routledge, 2000.
7. Skinner, Quentin, 'Social Meaning and the Explanation of Social Action' in Peter Laslett W.G Runciman and Quentin Skinner (eds), *Philosophy, Politics and Society,* Basil Blackwell: Oxford, 1972.
8. Verges-Gifra, Joan, 'Why Rawls Should Have Resisted the Hermeneutic Temptation', *Journal of Social Philosophy,* Vol 37, No 4, 2006.
9. Turner, Bryan (ed), *The New Blackwell Companion to Social Theory*, Wiley Blackwell: Sussex, 2009.
10. Williams, James, *Understanding Poststructuralism,* Acumen: Bucks, 2009.
11. McHoul Alec and Wendy Grace, *A Foucault Primer: Discourse, Power and the Subject,* Routledge: London and New York, 1993.
12. Elster, Jon, *Nuts and Bolts for the Social Sciences,* Cambridge: CUP, 1989.

Paper II: Methods in Social Science (Compulsory)

This course aims at equipping students with the knowledge and skills required to undertake systematic research. On completion of this course they should be able to develop their own research topics, frame research questions, and choose appropriate methodologies for data collection and analysis.

Preliminaries
Design of social and political research
Research Problem, Question and Design
Concepts, Hypothesis, Case selection
Operationalisation and Measurement
Comparative Analysis
Quantitative, Qualitative, Mixed methods

Data Collection
Types of Data: Primary and Secondary
Survey and opinion polls, Archival research, Official statistics
Documents and Texts as data sources
Interviews, Oral narratives, Participant observation, Field research
Specialised methods: Focus group, Life histories and Narrative inquiry, Films

Data Analysis
Data preparation, processing, interpretation and analysis
Quantitative data analysis: Descriptive and Inferential statistics
Qualitative data analysis: Miles and Huberman Framework, Discourse and Content analysis, Textual analysis

Select Readings

1. Black, Thomas R. 1999. *Doing quantitative research in the social sciences: an integrated approach to research design, measurement and statistics*. London: Sage Publications.
2. Blaikie, Norman W. H. 2003. *Analyzing quantitative data: from description to explanation*. London: Sage Publications.
3. Brady, Henry E. 2000. "Contributions of Survey Research to Political Science". *PS: Political Science and Politics.* 33 (1): 47-57.
4. Burgess, Robert G. 1984. *In the field: an introduction to field research*. Contemporary social research series, 8. London: Allen & Unwin.
5. Collier, David, and James E. Mahon. 1993. "Conceptual "Stretching" Revisited: Adapting Categories in Comparative Analysis". *American Political Science Review.* 87 (4): 845-855.
6. De Vaus, D. A. 2002. *Analyzing social science data*. London: Sage Publications.
7. Denzin, Norman K., and Yvonna S. Lincoln. 2005. *The sage handbook of qualitative research*. London: Sage Publications.
8. Desai, Vandana, and Robert B. Potter. 2006. *Doing development research*. London: Sage Publications.
9. Dey, Ian. 2003. *Qualitative Data Analysis: A user friendly guide for social scientists*, London: Routledge.
10. Eckstein, Harry. 1975. Case study and theory in political science. (eds.) Fred Greenstein and Nelson Polsby, *Handbook of Political Science*, *Volume 7: Strategies of Inquiry*. Reading, MA.: Addison-Wesley.94-137.

11. Flyvbjerg, Bent. 2006. "Five Misunderstandings about Case-Study Research", *Qualitative Inquiry*, 12 (2): 219-45.
12. Frankfort-Nachmias, Chava, and David Nachmias. 1996.*Research methods in the social sciences*. London: Arnold.
13. George L. Alexander and Andrew Bennett. 2005.*Case Studies and Theory Development in the Social Sciences* Cambridge, Massachusetts: MIT Press
14. Gerring, John. 2007. *Case study research: principles and practices*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
15. Gerring, John. 2011. *Social Science Methodology: A Unified Framework* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
16. Given, Lisa M. 2008. *The sage encyclopaedia of qualitative research methods.*Volumes 1 & 2. London: Sage Publications.
17. Goertz, Gary. 2006. *Social science concepts: a user's guide*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.
18. Grofman, Bernard. 2001. *Political science as puzzle solving*:*Interests, identities, and institutions in comparative politics*. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press.
19. Hollway, Wendy, and Tony Jefferson. 2000. *Doing qualitative research differently: free association, narrative and the interview method*. London: SAGE.
20. Holsti, Ole R. 1969. *Content analysis for the social sciences and humanities*. Reading, Mass: Addison-Wesley Pub. Co.
21. Johnson, Janet Buttolph, and Richard Joslyn. 1989. *Political science research methods*. New Delhi: Prentice-Hall of India.
22. King, Gary, Robert O. Keohane, and Sidney Verba. 1994.*Designing social inquiry scientific inference in qualitative research*. Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press.
23. Krippendorff, Klaus. 1980. *Content analysis: an introduction to its methodology*. Beverly Hills: Sage Publications.
24. Miles, Matthew B., and A. M. Huberman. 1994. *Qualitative data analysis: an expanded sourcebook*. London: Sage Publications.
25. *Porta Donatella della and Michael Keating*.2008. *Approaches and Methodologies in the Social Sciences: A Pluralist Perspective* Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
26. Punch, Keith and Keith Punch. 2003. *Survey research: the basics*. London: Sage Publications.
27. Silverman, David and Amir Marvasti.2008. *Doing Qualitative Research: A Comprehensive Guide*, London: SagePublications.
28. Thomas, George. 2005. "The Qualitative Foundations of Political Science Methodology". *Perspectives on Politics.* 3 (4): 855-866.
29. Trochim William, *Research methods knowledge base* (Trochim, William M. The Research Methods Knowledge Base, 2nd edition. Internet www page, at url: <http://www.socialresearchmethods.net/kb/> (version current as of October 20,2006)
30. Van Evera, Stephen. 1997. *Guide to methods for students of political science*. Ithaca: Cornell University Press.
31. Weber, Robert Philip. 1990. Basic content analysis, London: SagePublications
32. Wright, Daniel B. 1997. *Understanding statistics: an introduction for the social sciences*. London: Sage Publications.
33. Mouton, Johann and H C Marais. 1990. *Basic concepts in methodology of social sciences*. Pretoria: HSRC Publishers.
34. Creswell, W. John. 2007. *Qualitative inquiry and research design: choosing among five approaches*. London: Sage Publications.

Paper III : Reading and Writing in Social Sciences (Compulsory)

This course is aimed at developing critical reading and writing skills among students so that they can carry out research work. The students will be evaluated on the basis of 1. Literature Review on a chosen theme (50%) 2. Test (20%) 3. Book Review (15%) 4. Writing Summary/Abstract (15%).

Reading

1. Summarising the text
2. Discerning the research question, central argument, assumptions, evidence offered
3. Extracting author's contribution to the subject area
4. Identifying gaps and problems in – method, literature survey, data, approaches to the problem, interpretation

Writing

1. Choosing between Formats - Structuring the paper, Elements of Organisation and Presentation
2. Literature Review
3. Methodology, Sources/Data
4. Citation, References, Bibliography
5. Ethics in the Profession and Research
6. Language- Common mistakes, Sentence construction.

Reading List:

1. Brink-Budgen, Roy van den, 1999. *Critical Thinking for Students: How to Assess Arguments and Effectively Present Your Own,* How To Books Ltd: Oxford
2. Mayberry, Katherine, 2009. *Everyday Arguments: A Guide to Writing and Reading Effective Arguments,* Houghton Mifflin Company*:* Boston /New York
3. Weston, Anthony, 2009. *A Rule book for Arguments,* Hackett Publishing: Indiananpolis
4. Miller, Steven I, 1999. 'Teaching "Distinctions" to Undergraduates in the Philosophy of the Social Sciences', Analytic Teaching, Vol 18, No. 2
5. Resources available at Purdue Online Academic Lab. http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/section/1/2/

…….